
RUSEN BIRBEN

AI & DATA ENGINEER

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DOB 26/08/2002 | LICENSE B | STATUS AVAILABLE

01 SUMMARY

AI & Data Engineering graduate from Istanbul Technical University, currently an independent researcher at METU's Applied NLP Group working on LLMs, interpretability, and robustness. Experience across NLP, LLMs, and agentic AI applications; previously co-founded Fiction Studios at Bilkent Cyberpark, an AI startup that built LLM-powered guides for museums and tourists.

02 EXPERIENCE

Independent Researcher

04/2026 - Present

METU Applied NLP Group🔗

Ankara, TR

Lead METU NLP Connect, the lab's YouTube channel: expert interviews, educational explainers on LLMs and modern NLP, and recent-paper spotlights. Member of the Applied NLP Group (led by Asst. Prof. Çağrı Toraman), working on LLMs, generative AI, and Turkish language technologies.

Co-Founder

08/2025 - 04/2026

Fiction Studios🔗

Ankara, TR

Co-founded an AI startup at Bilkent Cyberpark, an accredited Turkish Teknokent. Built an LLM-powered guide app for museums and tourists. Wound down in 2026.

Junior AI Engineer

03/2025 - 07/2025

CyberQuote🔗

Istanbul, TR

Built AI automations and agentic LLM implementations for Phillip Capital subsidiary. Intelligent systems for operations and customer-facing platforms.

NLP Research Intern

07/2024 - 08/2024

ITU NLP Lab🔗

Istanbul, TR

Researched LLMs for financial applications: forecasting, sentiment analysis, tool usage, reasoning, and RAG implementations.

AIOps Research Intern

08/2024 - 09/2024

Havelsan🔗

Istanbul, TR

AIOps research using software log data for predictive maintenance. Generated demos on HDFS logs.

03 PROJECTS

Tobor	2024 – 2025
<i>Amazon Warehouse Robot</i>	
Autonomous warehouse robot simulating Amazon logistics. Pathfinding, obstacle avoidance, task scheduling. Human/cargo detection with custom YOLO.	
Python • ROS2 • YOLO • Robotics	 
Biting The Bytes	2024
<i>Turkish Diacritic Restoration</i>	
T5-based transformer for restoring Turkish diacritics. Automatically adds accent marks and special characters for enhanced readability.	
NLP • T5 • Transformers • Turkish	 HF 
AIzheimer	2024
<i>Machine Unlearning on SD</i>	
Selectively removed concepts from Stable Diffusion 2.1 while preserving other capabilities. Content moderation and AI output customization.	
Stable Diffusion • Unlearning • CV	
To-AI-or-Not-to-AI	2023
<i>GPT Detector</i>	
Ensemble method to detect AI-generated text using three fine-tuned models. Addresses academic integrity and misinformation concerns.	
NLP • Ensemble • Classification	 HF 
Anime Recommender	2022 – 2023
<i>Collaborative Filtering</i>	
Personalized anime recommendations combining collaborative filtering and content-based approaches. RMSE: 0.289, MAE: 0.213.	
RecSys • Matrix Factorization	

04 EDUCATION

B.Sc. AI and Data Engineering	2022 – 2025
<i>Istanbul Technical University</i>	GPA 3.61 / 4.00
B.Sc. Electronics & Communication	2020 – 2022
<i>Istanbul Technical University</i>	
<i>Transferred to AI & Data Engineering</i>	

05 AWARDS

1416 YLSY Scholarship • M.Sc. & Ph.D.	May 2026
<i>Türkiye Ministry of National Education</i>	
Türkiye's flagship state scholarship for graduate study abroad, established under Law No. 1416 (1929). Funds tuition, living stipend, travel, and exam fees for master's and doctoral programs in exchange for mandatory service at a Turkish university or public institution.	

06 COURSES

Deep Learning Specialization[↗](#) Deeplearning.ai · Andrew Ng
Sequence Models, CNNs, NN and DL basics, Structuring ML Projects, Improving Deep NNs.

AWS Cloud Technical Essentials[↗](#) AWS · Coursera
Core AWS concepts, security practices, EC2, Lambda, ECS, RDS, DynamoDB, S3.

07 SKILLS

LANGUAGES Python ▪ JavaScript/TypeScript ▪ SQL ▪ C/C++

FRAMEWORKS & TOOLS PyTorch ▪ TensorFlow ▪ ROS2 ▪ YOLO ▪ Transformers ▪ Scikit-learn ▪ Pandas ▪ NumPy

SPECIALTIES NLP ▪ LLMs ▪ Computer Vision ▪ RAG ▪ MLOps ▪ Agentic AI ▪ Data Engineering

08 LANGUAGES

Turkish (*Native*) **English** (*Fluent · TOEFL iBT 109*)

09 INTERESTS

Coffee · V60 - Aeropress - Moka Pot **Books** · Philosophy - AI/CS - Finance **Photography** · Street Photography - Double Exposure - Bird Photography **Anime & Manga** · Watcher - Reader - Collector
